



Vector Circle

STUDENT GUIDE · NIT SILCHAR

Track the courses. Hold the streak. Climb the board.

Vector Circle is where your circle works through a milestone together. A milestone is a syllabus — a set of courses, in order, with a deadline. Right now that milestone is RAG Specialist: 22 steps over 8 weeks, every course free.

You mark your own progress. Everyone can see it. That is the whole idea.

Getting started

Your admin gives you two things: your name (already in the app — you pick it from a list) and a PIN (temporary — you will choose your own in a minute). There is no signup, no email, no password. If your name is not in the list, you are not enrolled yet. Ask your admin.

1 · Open it

Go to the link your admin shared, then put it on your home screen — it opens full screen and loads faster. Android/Chrome: tap Install in the top bar. iPhone/Safari: Share → Add to Home Screen. You will see the day's quote first — the same one for everyone in the circle that day. Tap to move on.

2 · Pick your milestone

Tap RAG Specialist. The card shows how many courses, how many weeks, and how many students are in it.

3 · Sign in

Pick your name from the list — start typing to jump to it — and enter your PIN. Eight wrong tries locks the account for 15 minutes. That is deliberate: a 4-digit PIN is only 10,000 guesses.

4 · Choose your own PIN

The first time in, you must replace the PIN your admin gave you. You cannot skip it. Your admin knows that PIN, and so might whoever was standing nearby. Pick 4–6 digits only you know — six is much harder to guess than four. It cannot be 1234.

The four tabs

Track	Your courses, your dots. Where you will spend your time.
Board	The leaderboard.
Circle	Chat with everyone in this milestone.
Library	Papers and references. Not scored.

Track — the important one

At the top

- Your percentage and rank in the circle, and dots filled out of the milestone total.
- Courses open — e.g. 3 of 22. Your admin opens the syllabus week by week, so most of it starts locked. Nothing is broken.
- Pace — ahead, on pace, or behind. The white tick on the bar is where you should be today.

- The reward — what the first person to finish takes.

Study streak

Tap Log today, enter the minutes you studied, done. It counts consecutive days — miss one and it resets to zero. It shows on the board as a flame next to your name. It is not part of your rank: it is a separate, honest signal about whether you are actually showing up.

Dots — how progress works

Ten dots per course. Tap the dot you have reached — tap dot 6 and you are at 6/10. Tap the dot you are already on to step back one. Ten dots turn green: that course is done.

There is no “done” button on purpose. A five-hour course is not done or not-done for most of a week — it is somewhere in between, and your circle should be able to see that you are moving.

A rough guide. Dots are how far through it you are. Halfway through the videos is 5. Finished the videos but have not touched the code is about 7. Finished, coded along, and you could explain it to someone else is 10.

Nobody checks. Dots are yours to set. You could put 10 on everything in a minute and top the board by lunchtime. You would also walk into an interview unable to answer the first question, and everyone would find out then instead of now. The board is a mirror, not a scoreboard.

Locked courses

Dashed border, dimmed, an amber locked tag. You can read the title, the provider and what it teaches — you just cannot start it or mark dots yet. They stay visible so you can see the whole road. Your admin opens them when the circle gets there.

Notes

Tap Notes on any open course to ask a doubt or leave a tip. It stays attached to that course, so the next person who hits the same wall finds your question — and your answer — exactly where they need it. This is the best thing you can do for your circle. Post the thing that confused you.

Board

Ranked on total dots. Ties go to whoever got there first.

- Your row is outlined so you can find yourself. Medals for the top three.
- A flame and a number is that person’s current study streak.
- The strip under each name is their whole milestone — one bar per course, filled to their dots. Faint bars are courses still locked. You can read someone’s month in half a second.
- When someone clears every dot, they get a banner at the top.

Rank moves as people work. Being behind in week 2 means nothing. Being behind in week 7 means something.

Circle

The chat room for everyone in this milestone. Course-specific doubts belong in Notes on the course card — that is where they stay useful. Circle is for everything else: study sessions, links, someone talking themselves out of quitting on a Wednesday. If your admin has turned off your posting you will still read everything; the box will tell you so.

Library

Papers, documentation and tools worth reading. Not tracked, not scored, no dots. Read these when a course leaves you with a question.

Your account

Tap the circle with your initial, top right: Change PIN (you will need your current one) and Sign out. Next to it, the sun/moon button switches light and dark — it follows your phone by default and remembers once you choose.

Forgot your PIN? Ask your admin to reset it. You will get a temporary one and be asked to choose a new PIN when you sign in. Nobody can recover your old one — not even the admin.

The RAG Specialist milestone

Eight weeks, 22 steps, from what an LLM is to a deployed system you can demo.

Week	What you are doing
1	Foundations — what LLMs do, prompting, transformers
2	The RAG core, plus the original paper
3	Embeddings and vector search
4	Build it — LangChain, and ship RAG v1 on your own documents
5	Data quality and better retrieval
6	Evaluation — put numbers on your own system
7	Knowledge graphs, agentic RAG, multimodal
8	LLMOps, and deploy a capstone with a written case study

Weeks 4, 6 and 8 are not courses — they are things you build. Nineteen finished courses and no repository does not make you a specialist, and a placement panel finds that out in about four minutes. The checkpoints are what you actually talk about in the interview. Give them the time they need.

If something goes wrong

My name is not in the listYou are not enrolled in that milestone. Check you picked the right one, then ask your ad	
“That PIN does not match”	Wrong PIN, or wrong milestone. Eight tries locks it for 15 minutes.
“Too many wrong PINs”	Wait it out. It stops someone guessing into your account.
A dot will not fill	A red message says why. If the database refused it, reload — the course may have just been unlock
Everything looks locked	Normal at the start. Your admin opens each week when the circle gets there.
“Behind pace” in week 1	Pace compares your dots against the whole milestone. Early on this reads harsh. Watch the trend, n
The app looks stale	Pull down to refresh, or close and reopen it from your home screen.

Three things worth knowing

The dots are for you. Nobody audits them. Their only value is that they are true.

Post the thing that confused you. Twenty people studying the same syllabus alone is twenty people stuck on the same question. The Notes box is what makes it a circle.

Show up more than you catch up. Forty minutes a day beats six hours on Sunday, every time. That is what the streak measures, and it is the only number here that predicts whether you will finish.